



AFRICAN CONNECTIONS
"Your Gateway to Africa"

Welcomes You to Ghana



inikwani dehina met'ahi (Welcome in Amharic)

Thank you for choosing African Connections to provide comprehensive tour services for your upcoming “Ethiopia & Ghana Return to the Motherland Tour” scheduled for September 6th - 15th 2026 (9 nights/10 days).

African Connections, “AC” is your Gateway to Africa. We have been a leader in African travel for over 20 years and the entire AC Team is preparing for your upcoming visit to Ethiopia and Ghana.

We pride ourselves on delivery of outstanding concierge services and we are happy to assist you and provide you with information you'll need to prepare for your journey.

When you reach Ethiopia and Ghana, we will meet you at the airport when you arrive and assist you throughout your stay in Ethiopia and Ghana.

Our team is knowledgeable and professional and proud to show you the wonders of Ethiopia and Ghana, countries we know so well.

This welcome guide will provide you with information that will be helpful as you make your travel preparations.

Please review this information carefully. We welcome your questions and look forward to seeing you in Ethiopia and Ghana soon!

Your Tour

You should book your tickets so that you depart from the USA on September 5th 2026, with your arrival in Ethiopia on September 6th 2026.

Your tickets should have you depart from Ghana on September 15th 2026, and arrive back in the United States on September 16th 2026.

Your tour begins when you arrive in Ethiopia on September 6th and ends when we see you off at the airport on September 15th 2026.

Ghana Travel Requirements

Ghana is a tourist-friendly destination, but it is important that you are aware of travel requirements and have your travel documents ready well before your departure date. Please read the following information carefully.

Passports and Visas

A valid passport is required for all international travel. Your passport must be valid for at least six months after the date of your scheduled arrival back in the United States. Check your passport expiration date to be sure it meets this requirement and if necessary, apply for a renewal as soon as possible. You will not be allowed to board your departure flight from United States if your passport expiration date is within six months of your scheduled return date.

You must also have a valid visa to enter Ghana. For further information, contact the Embassy of Ghana in Washington DC at visa@ghanaembassydc.org or telephone at (202) 686-4520.

We recommend contacting a visa service provider if you need further assistance obtaining your visa.

Please Note: You should not submit your application earlier than 90 days before your departure date. So, your visa application should be submitted no earlier than early April 2026.

Immunization and Medical Information

Yellow Fever:

Travelers above nine (9) months old who come to Ghana are required to have been vaccinated against Yellow Fever at least ten days before the proposed date of travel. Where already vaccinated, the duration of the vaccination status should not be more than ten years before entering Ghana. However, travelers over 60 years of age can obtain a Medical Letter of Exemption (MLOE) from their healthcare provider if he/she advises that the individual should not receive a Yellow Fever vaccination.

If you obtain a Medical Letter of Exemption, it should be included with your travel documents.

If you get the Yellow Fever vaccine, be sure this is indicated in your yellow International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis (ICVP). **It is your responsibility to comply with all immunization requirements.**

Malaria Prevention and Other Immunizations:

Your doctor might also recommend other vaccinations which are not mandatory for travel to Ghana. It is up to you to decide if you take any or all such recommended vaccinations as they are not required for entry into Ghana.

While it is not mandatory, we strongly recommend that you acquire anti-malarial medication. Malaria is a serious potential (but treatable) health threat, and you should take necessary precautions to minimize your risk.

It is also a good idea to bring your favorite mosquito repellant to further protect yourself from mosquitos.

Prescription Medications:

If you take prescription medication, you are responsible for determining their legality in Ghana and note the following:

- We advise you to bring enough of your medication with you.
- Always keep your medication in the original container.
- Carry a copy of your prescription(s).
- Pack your medicine in your carry-on luggage, not your checked luggage.

Travel Insurance

Travel Insurance is not included in your package. However, it is strongly recommended that you purchase travel insurance to cover any unexpected event that might interrupt or prevent your travel.

Our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click on the link below or go to our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

<https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&accam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTF TOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMNXVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU>

Shopping in Ghana

You will love shopping in Ghana!!! There will be countless opportunities to buy so many unique items in Ghana. You can buy beautiful cloth and have clothes tailor made for you; and you will be overwhelmed with the choices of beautiful and unique ready-made clothes on offer. There will be art, 18 kt gold jewelry, beads, wood sculptures, baskets, brass and so much more!

With all the bargains and beautiful items that you will find in Ghana, you shouldn't be surprised if you end up over your airline's baggage allowance. If this happens you have several options. You can pay the excess baggage fee charged by your airline and carry the extra baggage with you, or you might decide to air freight or ship items.

Clothing and Packing

You probably have a two-checked bag allowance. We strongly recommend that you only pack one suitcase and bring one empty suitcase when you come to Ghana, so you have that extra suitcase for the things that you buy in Ghana. The question sometimes comes up as to whether it would be best to just bring one suitcase and buy a second suitcase in Ghana. This is not recommended as suitcases are expensive in Ghana and the selection and quality might not be what you expect. Just in case you exceed the airline's baggage requirement, we recommend that you carefully review the airline's excess baggage rules and fees before you arrive in Ghana.

It is advisable for you to pack lightly. You will no doubt buy clothing while in Ghana and there will be opportunities for you to have your clothes washed at the hotels at very reasonable prices. Bring a few interchangeable outfits that are comfortable and washable. Cotton or other fabrics that breathe will help you to stay comfortable. It will be warm in Ghana. We advise that you bring a light sweater or jacket for evenings and early morning. We further advise that you wear comfortable shoes/sandals.

Don't bring electrical appliances and gadgets. The electric outlets in Ghana are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. **This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Ghana. The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Ghana.** You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Ghana are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

You can bring your own adapter or buy one when you arrive as adapters are very inexpensive in Ghana and are readily available.

Toiletries/Personal Items

Be sure you bring all your toiletries and personal items. While you will have opportunities to buy such things in Ghana, you might not be able to find the brands you prefer.

Customs Requirements

Passengers' obligations at Ghana Customs are outlined on the Ghana Revenue Authority website, see [GRA – Ghana Revenue Authority](#) for details.

When you arrive in Ghana you will pass through Ghana Customs, and you might be asked if you have anything to declare. You must declare any commercial goods or currency more than \$10,000 you bring into Ghana.

Money/Credit and Debit Cards/ATM's:

Cash

There is no limit on how much money you can bring into Ghana. However, as stated above, if you bring in more than \$10,000 in cash, you must declare it when you pass through customs on entry. If you bring in less than \$10,000, there is no need to declare any cash that you bring in.

You will have several opportunities to change your dollars for the local currency during your stay in Ghana. Please note that it is advisable that you bring any cash that you bring in either \$100 or \$50 bills, as smaller denominations will be exchanged for a significantly lower exchange rate.

ATMs

There are ATMs in all the major cities you visit, but you will pay an international fee and a local bank fee for ATM transactions in addition to possibly receiving a lower exchange rate for each transaction.

Credit and Debit Cards

There will be a few places where you can use your credit or debit card, but for the most part, Ghana is a cash economy. If you do intend to use your debit or credit card, when this option is available,

you should inform your bank that you are traveling to Ghana to prevent a fraud alert or possible block of your card when you try to use it in Ghana.

Also, note that many businesses that take debit or credit cards use POS equipment that requires a PIN number. While we all know our debit card PIN number, most of us do not have or know our credit card PIN number. So, if you intend to use a credit card, contact your bank and make sure you have and know the PIN number associated with the card.

Note: Visa and Mastercard are widely accepted in Ghana. Just a few merchants accept American Express and Discover is not accepted anywhere in Ghana.

Food and Water

Your tour package includes breakfast daily and other specified meals (lunch/dinner), including a Welcome Dinner with Cultural Performances.

You will be able to buy meals that are not included in the tour package at restaurants that we have carefully selected. There will be many food choices, and you will be able to sample delicious Ghanaian dishes as well as more familiar dishes. The average cost of a meal with a soft drink and water in Ghana ranges from \$15-\$25.

Bottled water is readily available. However, the water in all the hotels and restaurants that have been selected for you is potable and safe to drink or to use when brushing your teeth. Using the ice cubes provided at restaurants and your hotel is also safe. While some of your favorite snacks might be available in Ghana, and we will make regular stops for you to stock up on snacks, fruit, and drinks during the trip, you should bring the special snacks you prefer.

Hotels and Restaurants in Ghana:

Hotels

You will be staying at hotels carefully selected to ensure your comfort. These hotels are highly rated, with clean, comfortable rooms and well-trained staff. However, standards might vary from those to which you might be accustomed. For example, while bath towels and hand towels are available and supplied at all the selected hotels, facecloths are generally not available. So, you should bring your own face clothes. Rest assured; our ground staff will be available to address any issue that might arise.

Restaurants

We have carefully selected each of the restaurants you will visit on your tour. These restaurants will provide clean, wholesome food, giving you the choice of local Ghanaian dishes or more familiar continental dishes.

While the food is tasty, Ghanaian restaurants are known for slow service, so you might have to exercise patience before your meal arrives. Whenever possible, our staff will help you place your order before arrival at a restaurant to cut down on the wait time.

Cell Phone/Data Usage and Internet Service:

Before your departure to Ghana, contact your mobile phone service provider and request international data service to access WhatsApp or similar apps for internet-based communications. Such communications are significantly less costly than international roaming charges. You could also ask for a one-month international voice package. While this could be costly, it is cheaper than the bill you will receive if you make calls without a call package.

Suppose you make or receive international calls while you are in Ghana, and you do not have the appropriate international call/data packages. In that case, you will be shocked when you receive your telephone service billing statement. Also, disable your data roaming function as soon as you arrive to prevent billing shocks!

Mobile phone and internet services are available in Ghana. Upon arrival tourists may purchase tourist sim cards for use in their unlocked phones. You can purchase an unlocked phone in Ghana for less than \$50. The local service provider will then activate your sim card for the period of your stay in Ghana.

Other information that might be helpful as you prepare for your trip:

Country Profile:

Ghana is a country with a reputation for being one of the friendliest in Africa. With un-spoilt beaches, natural attractions, and vibrant cosmopolitan cities. Ghana is a country that has a rich ethnic diversity, abundant historical legacies, a strong cultural heritage, and traditions. Visitors to

Ghana can expect to be greeted by a sense of history and met with exceptional hospitality that has long been associated with its people.

Geography:

Ghana, which lies in the center of the West African coast, shares borders with the three French-speaking nations of Côte d'Ivoire to the west, Togo to the east, and Burkina Faso (Burkina, formerly Upper Volta) to the north. To the south are the Gulf of Guinea and the Atlantic Ocean. With a total area of 109,472 square miles, Ghana is about the twice the size of the state of New York. The topography of Ghana is varied and consists of tropical forests, savannahs, mountains, and the coastal ranges. While much of Ghana is rural there are many metropolitan areas including Accra the capital city that has an estimated population of 4 million, and Kumasi which has an estimated population of 3.5 million.

Economy:

Ghana is well endowed with natural resources, including gold, oil, and bauxite. Agriculture accounts for roughly one-third of Ghana's GDP and employs more than half of the workforce. In addition, the economy is based on manufacturing, automotive and ship construction and is a commercial and business hub for West Africa.

Currency:

The Ghanaian Cedi is the currency of Ghana. The currency code for Cedis is GHS, and the symbol is GH¢. The cedi to dollar exchange rate changes frequently. You will be able to exchange dollars for cedis when you arrive in Ghana at the prevailing rate at that time. There is no limit on the amount of cash you bring into Ghana, but you must declare any amounts over \$10,000. Lesser amounts do not need to be declared.

Language:

Ghana's official language is English, and all schoolchildren learn It early in life. Therefore, you should not have difficulty communicating with locals and thoroughly enjoying every aspect of your stay in Ghana.

Government:

The constitution of Ghana was adopted in 1992, establishing a constitutional democratic government consisting of three branches: The Executive, Parliament, and Judiciary.

Ghana is divided into sixteen regions. The President, Vice President, and members of Parliament are elected by popular vote. Elections are held once every four years.

Current President: His Excellency Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo

Current Vice-President: Dr. Mahamudu Bawumia

History:

The country now known as Ghana has a long and rich history. Its history includes great kingdoms and ancient empires. Before the Europeans arrived in search of gold, the west coast of Africa was part of an ancient trade route. In 1471, Portuguese traders came ashore and noticed that the local people wore gold jewelry. People from Portugal, Denmark, the Netherlands, Germany, and Britain came to the Gold Coast to search for gold and subsequently engaged in the transatlantic slave trade.

After the British took control of the Gold Coast, it was declared a colony of the British Empire. In 1957, the Gold Coast gained its independence from Britain and became known as Ghana.

Climate:

In September, Ghana is in the midst of its rainy season, especially in the southern and coastal regions. The weather during this month is generally warm and humid, with periodic rainfall that helps keep the landscapes lush and green. In southern cities like Accra, Cape Coast, and Takoradi, daytime temperatures typically range between 75°F and 86°F (24°C to 30°C). While showers are common—often in the afternoon or evening—they are usually brief and followed by sunny or partly cloudy skies. In the northern regions such as Tamale and Bolgatanga, September marks the tail end of the rainy season. These areas experience heavier rains earlier in the month, gradually transitioning to drier conditions toward October. Daytime temperatures in the north can be warmer, often reaching 88°F to 95°F (31°C to 35°C), with high humidity levels.

Travelers visiting Ghana in September should be prepared for occasional rain, especially if exploring the coastal and forest zones. However, the rainfall brings cooler breezes and vibrant natural scenery, making it a pleasant time to visit national parks, waterfalls, and cultural sites. Light, breathable clothing and a travel umbrella or rain jacket are recommended, along with sturdy footwear for wet or muddy conditions.

Frequently Asked Questions

General Travel Information

1. Do I need a visa to visit Ghana?

Yes, U.S. citizens need a visa to enter Ghana. You can apply for a visa at the Ghanaian Embassy or Consulate at the US before traveling. Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your travel dates.

2. What vaccinations do I need before traveling?

A Yellow Fever vaccination is required for entry into Ghana. Other recommended vaccines include Hepatitis A & B, typhoid, tetanus, and malaria prophylaxis. Bring a copy of your vaccination records with you on your trip.

3. Is Ghana safe for tourists?

Ghana is considered one of the safest countries in West Africa. However, travelers should stay alert in crowded places, avoid carrying large amounts of cash, and use reputable transportation services.

4. What is the best time to visit Ghana?

Travelers visiting Ghana in September should be prepared for occasional rain, especially if exploring the coastal and forest zones. However, the rainfall brings cooler breezes and vibrant natural scenery, making it a pleasant time to visit national parks, waterfalls, and cultural sites.

5. What is the dress code in Ghana?

Ghana has a warm climate, so light and breathable clothing is recommended. When visiting religious or traditional sites, modest dressing is advised.

6. Are public toilets available at tourist sites?

Public toilets are available at the sites we visit but it is advisable to carry tissues and hand sanitizer.

7. Is there internet access?

Hotels, restaurants, and cafes in major cities provide Wi-Fi. Also, before your departure to Ghana, contact your mobile phone service provider and request international data service to access WhatsApp or similar apps for internet-based communications. Such communications are significantly less costly than international roaming charges. Mobile phone and internet services are available in Ghana. Upon arrival tourists may purchase tourist SIM cards for use in their unlocked phones. You can purchase an unlocked phone in Ghana for less than \$50. The local service provider will then activate your SIM card for the period of your stay in Ghana.

8. **Is it allowed to take photographs of people?**

You can take pictures of locals, especially in markets and rural areas. However, it is advisable that you ask for permission before taking pictures.

9. **What fitness level is required for sightseeing?**

A moderate fitness level is recommended. Some attractions, like waterfalls and hiking trails, may require more physical activity.

10. **What kind of shoes should I wear?**

Comfortable walking shoes are recommended, as some areas have uneven terrain and dusty roads.

11. **How is the power supply in Ghana?**

The electric outlets in Ghana are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Ghana. The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Ghana. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Ghana are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

12. **Can I drink alcohol in Ghana?**

Yes, alcohol is available in restaurants and bars. The local beers and palm wine are popular choices.

13. **Is smoking allowed in Ghana?**

Smoking is permitted in outdoor areas but is restricted in enclosed public spaces.

14. **What food options are available in Ghana?**

Ghanaian cuisine includes dishes like jollof rice, banku, fufu, and grilled tilapia. Street food is popular, but it's advisable to eat from reputable vendors.

Money & Costs

15. What currency is used in Ghana?

The Ghanaian Cedi (GHS) is the official currency. Credit cards are accepted in major hotels and restaurants, but cash is preferred for small purchases.

16. How much does a meal cost in Ghana?

A meal at a mid-range restaurant costs about GHS 60-100 (\$15-\$25), while street food or casual dining can be around GHS 20-50 (\$10-\$15).

17. Can I use U.S. dollars in Ghana?

U.S. dollars are not widely accepted, so it's best to exchange your money at banks or Forex Bureaus.

Transportation & Getting Around

18. Do I need an international driver's license to rent a car?

Yes, an International Driving Permit (IDP) is required, but most tourists prefer hiring a driver due to local traffic conditions.

19. Is public transportation safe?

Public transport such as shared minibuses (tro-tros) can be crowded and confusing for tourists. Taxis, ride-hailing services like Bolt, and private tours are safer and more convenient.

Health & Safety

20. Is tap water safe to drink?

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels and the

restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

21. Do I need travel insurance?

Yes, travel insurance is highly recommended for medical emergencies, lost luggage, and trip cancellations.

However, our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTF TOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMN XVK 3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

22. Should I bring my own medicine?

Bring sufficient prescribed medication for your trip. Pharmacies are available, but specific medicines may not always be in stock.

23. Is malaria a concern in Ghana?

Malaria is present in Ghana year-round, with a higher risk during the rainy season. Talk to your doctor about malaria prevention medication.

Activities

24. Is there time for shopping?

Yes! Ghana is known for its vibrant markets, where you can buy kente cloth, beads, wooden carvings, and handmade crafts.

25. Can I make personal purchases?

Yes, budget around GHS 50-100 (\$8-\$15) per day for personal expenses like snacks, drinks, and souvenirs. Larger purchases can be made with credit cards in major stores.

Prepare to be Amazed!

Beneath the glittering façade of modern Ghana is a country at the crossroads of the modern, the ancient, the indigenous, and the exotic. Ghana is unique and unforgettable! Have your cameras ready!

The African Connections' Team is eagerly awaiting your arrival in Ghana, and we are ready to assist you as you prepare for your African Adventure!